



ABORIGINES

THE ANCIENT PEOPLE OF AUSTRALIA

lived in every incredibly different region of this enormous country. While all native Australians are known as Aborigines, there are

Arnhem Land

One of the areas of Australia where traditional Aboriginal culture has remained intact is Arnhem Land, situated in the far north of the Northern Territories. The land is all Aboriginal owned and outsiders may only visit with permission. Here the people choose to live in accordance with their original culture.



FAMILY LIFE

The Aboriginal family unit is large and extended. The raising of children is not just the duty of the parents, but of the entire community. These family systems are central to the way each society is organized and the close family ties ensure that the traditional culture is kept alive. Elders are treated with great respect—they are the bridge between past and present.



CITY LIFE

Not all Aboriginal Australians live a traditional way of life. Many of them now live in major cities, such as Sydney, and lead more Westernized lives.



MODERN CONVENIENCES

Although the people of Arnhem Land choose to live very traditionally, they also make good use of the modern world. These men are using one recently installed telephone to check that neighbors will be coming to a ceremony.

BUSH TUCKER

The Aborigines only take from the “bush,” or land, what is needed and always make sure that game and plants can regenerate. Children are taught to hunt when very young.

